

A product can become modular long before its quality model does.

Teams split. APIs multiply. QA stays organized as if one team still owns the whole application.

Architecture evolved. Quality ownership did not.

Architecture

domains
services
APIs
partners
independent releases

Quality model

one central QA queue
unclear ownership
late integration testing
end-to-end surprises

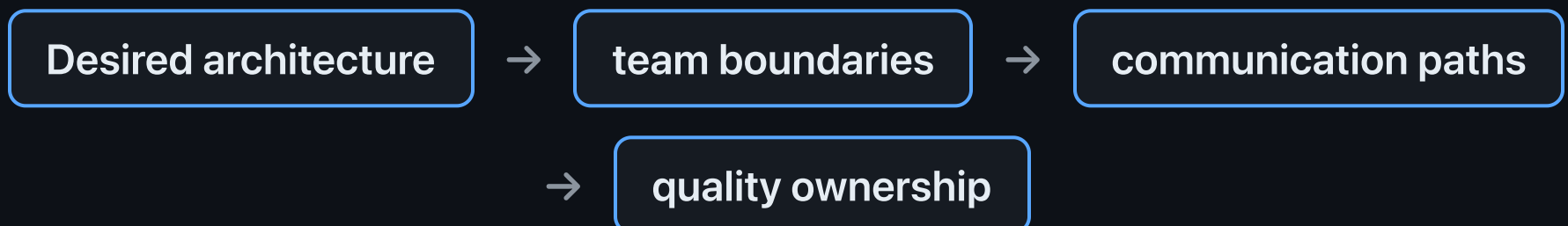
Conway's Law

**Systems often mirror the communication structures
of the organizations that build them.**

Team boundaries become architecture boundaries.

The Inverse Conway Maneuver

Design the team boundaries you need to support the architecture you want.



Shift one:

Quality ownership follows the capability.

- **functional correctness**
- **API and event contracts**
- **compatibility**
- **regression safety**
- **operational readiness**

Shift two:

Accountability follows the business outcome.

A successful order is more than a successful checkout response.

- created once
- priced correctly
- accepted downstream
- recoverable after failure
- traceable end to end

Shift three:

Central QA becomes enablement and governance.

- standards
- test platforms
- specialist expertise
- evidence models
- risk governance
- independent assessment

At every important boundary, ask:

Who fixes it?

Who proves it?

Who is alerted when it fails?

If there is no answer, the boundary is not operationally owned.

Tests follow architectural boundaries.
Accountability follows business outcomes.

Where does quality ownership disappear between teams in **your** organization?